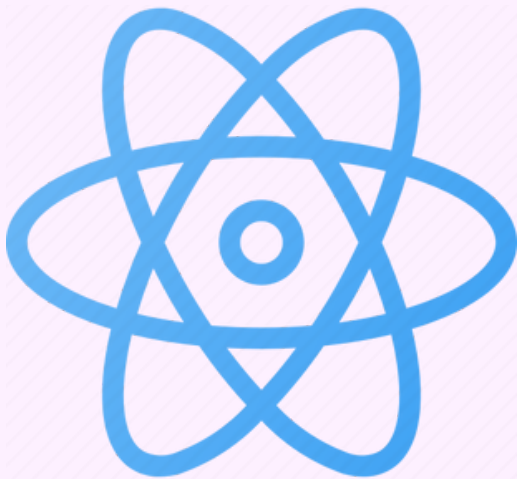


What is i18n and how to apply it in React?



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il8n

il8n (internationalization) is the process of designing your application in a way that it can be adapted for various languages and regions without requiring major changes to the code.

The term "il8n" is a numeronym, where "l8" represents the number of letters between the "i" and "n" in the word "i-**n**ternational**izatio**n".

How to Apply il8n in React

To implement il8n in a React app, a common approach is to use the react-il8next library, which integrates well with React components.

Steps to Implement i18n in React:

To implement i18n (internationalization) in React, you can use the popular `react-i18next` library. Here's a simple and short way to get started:

install the package

- *`npm install react-i18next i18next`*

Create your translation files:

- Create a folder named `locales` with JSON files for each language.

Example structure

```
/my-react-app
/public
/src
  /locales
    /en
      translation.json // English translations
    /et
      translation.json // Amharic translations
  /components
    App.js // Main React component
    i18n.js // i18n configuration
  package.json
  ...
```

Example structure (cont'd)

locales/en/translation.json

```
{  
  "welcome": "Welcome",  
  "description": "This is a simple i18n example"  
}
```

locales/et/translation.json

```
{  
  "welcome": "እንኳን ይህን መግቢያ",  
  "description": "ይህ አገልግሎት ቀላል እና አግባብ ትርጉም ምሳሌ ነው"  
}
```

Initialize i18n:

- Create a file i18n.js for configuration.

```
// i18n.js
import i18n from 'i18next';
import { initReactI18next } from 'react-i18next';
import translationEN from '../locales/en/translation.json';
import translationET from '../locales/et/translation.json'; // Amharic translation

const resources = {
  en: { translation: translationEN },
  et: { translation: translationET } // Ethiopian Amharic
};

i18n
  .use(initReactI18next)
  .init({
    resources,
    lng: 'en', // default language is English
    interpolation: { escapeValue: false }
  });

export default i18n;
```

Use the i18n in your React component:

```
// App.js
import React from 'react';
import { useTranslation } from 'react-i18next';
import './i18n'; // Make sure to import the i18n config

function App() {
  const { t, i18n } = useTranslation();

  const changeLanguage = (lang) => {
    i18n.changeLanguage(lang);
  };

  return (
    <div>
      <h1>{t('welcome')}</h1>
      <p>{t('description')}</p>
      <button onClick={() => changeLanguage('en')}>English</button>
      <button onClick={() => changeLanguage('et')}>Amharic</button>
    </div>
  );
}

export default App;
```

Explanation

- `il8n.js`: Initializes the `il8next` instance with translation resources.
- `App.js`: Uses the `useTranslation` hook to access the `t` function, which retrieves the corresponding translation for the current language. The `changeLanguage` function switches between languages.